

AGENDA: WEEK ONE

Revised 9/2025

1. Please join us in the Serenity Prayer
2. Introductions all around
3. Welcome...
 - To the 4th Step Workshop (regular AA meeting is downstairs)
 - 6 continuous Tuesdays from 7:00-8:30 pm
 - Homework assigned each week (each week increasing)
 - Very Important to attend all 6 evenings. See us for assignment if unable to attend.
 - Ask for volunteers to greet, move tables back and stack chairs each session
4. A Little Housekeeping...
 - When the door is closed before 7 pm, we are doing some prep work
 - Please silence your cell phone
 - Different 12 step groups are represented here tonight, so please be considerate
 - Speak loudly and clearly so all can hear what you have to share
 - Raise your hand if you can't hear others or the Facilitators
 - Circulate attendance sheet (for our use)
 - Pass the basket to help cover cost for workshop space rental, materials, etc
 - Suggested donation is \$20 for entire workshop (only if able)
 - Bathrooms are down the hall all the way on your right
5. Facilitators tell why they are here (1-2 minutes max time)
6. Read "About The Workshop"
7. Read "Disclaimer"
8. Discussion Topics to Address
 - Stress importance of sponsorship through this process
 - Helpful if sponsor is familiar with this process (they can call Facilitators)
 - Temporary sponsors are available if you don't have one
 - Discuss perils of sponsoring someone in the workshop while taking it yourself
 - Emphasize benefits of keeping up with homework assignments
9. This workshop originated from the Big Book of Alcoholics Anonymous. We have many 12th step groups represented here. The workshop works for all groups but may differ from some.
10. We have a few minutes. Would any care to share why they are here? (5 to 7 minutes max)

11. Pull out the handout called “Road Chart to Decision”

- If you are here, you should have worked Steps 2,2 and 3.
- Explain chart: Steps 1,2, & 3

12. We are now at Step 4: “Made a searching and fearless moral inventory of ourselves”

13. Set Aside Prayer: *God, Please help me set aside everything I think I know about myself, my disease, the 12 steps, and especially You, So I may have an open mind and a new experience of all these things. Please let me see the truth.*

14. (Announcement)

- If anyone feels uncomfortable with continuing at anytime, please talk to one of us after the session
- Again, it is important that you commit to all 6 weeks of the workshop. If you know that you must miss a week, talk to a Facilitator in advance.

14b. Readings

We have some readings for you. They are with your materials and are from three different sources: The Big Book of Alcoholics Anonymous, The Steps We Took, by Joe McQ and The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

15. The beginning of the 4th Step starts in The Big Book (pg. 63 Paragraph 4 through top of pg. 64):

“Next we launched out on a course of vigorous action, the first step of which is a personal house cleaning, which many of us had never attempted. Though our decision was a vital and crucial step, it could have little permanent effect unless at once followed by a strenuous effort to face, and be rid of, the things in ourselves which had been blocking us. Our liquor was but a symptom. So we had to get down to causes and conditions.”

- This is not about good or bad. It is just about what has stood in our way.

16. Continuing in The Big Book on page 64...

“Therefore, we started upon a personal inventory. THIS WAS STEP FOUR. A business which takes no regular inventory usually goes broke. Taking a commercial inventory is a fact-finding and fact-facing process. It is an effort to discover the truth about the stock-in-trade. One object is to disclose damages or unsalable goods, to get rid of them promptly and without regret. If the owner of the business is to be successful, he cannot fool himself about values.

We did exactly the same thing with our lives. We took stock honestly. First, we searched out the flaws in our make-up, which caused our failure. Being convinced that self, manifested in various ways, was what had defeated us, we considered its common manifestations.”

- Tell an Inventory story ??? [Suggest we write one out so anyone can read it?]

17. [More Discussion]:

- a. Talk about Joe and Charley
- b. Talk about Joe McQ writing the book The Steps We Took
- c. Ask participants to pull out handout entitled “Step 4 Inventory Comparison”
- d. Read bottom paragraph and explain comparison between Business & Personal - NOT ABOUT GOOD OR BAD
- e. Ask participants to pull out “The Glossary” & we read the definition of Resentments
- f. Ask participants to pull out the “Review of Resentments” sheets - Broken down into four columns, which we will talk about more later
- g. Column 1 is who or what we have a resentment towards

18. Continuing the reading from The Big Book on page 64, it states...

“Resentment is the “number one” offender. It destroys more alcoholics than anything else. From it stem all forms of spiritual disease, for we have been not only mentally and physically ill, we have been spiritually sick. When the spiritual malady is overcome, we straighten out mentally and physically. In dealing with resentments, we set them on paper. We listed people, institutions or principles with whom we were angry.” (Big Book page 64)

19. Joe McQ, on page 61 in his book, The Steps We Took

“We keep our minds on this predominant thought: We list all the names of people or institutions or principles for whom we have resentments. We make this list before we add anything about what the resentment is. We write just the names of all the people or things we have resentments against, left column, top to bottom, one thing at a time, just the names. We can remember these. We exhaust all of the resentments we have, identifying them by the names of people.

A mistake a lot of people make here is trying to list a person’s name, then going right across the page to the next columns and analyzing the resentment. But this means we have to change our minds four times as we list each resentment, to think about four different things about each resentment. This inevitably leads to confusion. It is better to name everyone and everything that we resent first, just thinking about one resentment at a time, working from top to bottom, of this column. Then we move over and start the next column.”

20. Work Column One “Board” Examples (People, Institutions, Principles)

- a. Top to Bottom
- b. Take Questions

21. Now on to Column Two

- a. What they did to offend us
- b. Joe McQ, on page 61, paragraph 3 in his book, The Steps We Took, explains Column Two this way...

“So it is simple. We ask first, “Who are the people and things that I resent?” When we’ve finished making this list, we go on to the next column, and to the next most vivid thing in our memory, “What did he or she do to me?” We don’t usually have any trouble remembering this either!! Beside each name, in the second column, we put down the cause associated with that person or thing. These are very vivid; everyone readily remembers them. Some of them we have been replaying in our minds for years and years. We know what they are. We put all these down from top to bottom. “

22. Work Column Two “Board” Examples – The Cause (People, Institutions, Principles)

- a. Top to Bottom
- b. Reminder to look at the handout “Areas to look for resentments”
- c. Take Questions

23. Assignments

- a. Columns 1 & 2 of Review of Resentments worksheet
- b. Talk about covering right hand columns as you work on the first two
- c. Talk about being specific in Column 2 (“like the time when...”)
- d. Talk about printing extra copies of second worksheet
- e. Read & re-read the definition of Resentments
- f. Call your sponsor
- g. Use the phone list and call/text Facilitators with questions

24. Please join us in the Serenity Prayer